

PROCEDURES FOR DEALING WITH BLOODBORNE DISEASES

Loudoun County Public Schools will follow Center for Disease Control and Prevention guidelines and Virginia Code, §32.1-45.1. The following procedures will guide administrators and school staff who identify or suspect a bloodborne disease in the school setting or when an exposure to blood or bodily fluids occurs.

A. School administration should contact the Supervisor of Student Health Services when a bloodborne disease is suspected. The Supervisor of Student Health Services will contact the Loudoun County Health Department to obtain guidance and to assist in making decisions regarding excluding a student from school or school related functions.

B. If it is the judgment of the Loudoun County Health Department, after consultation with private physicians or other public health officials, that a bloodborne disease is present in the school division and that there is a significant risk of transmission or that the risk of transmission is unknown, the administrator in collaboration with the Supervisor of Student Health Services shall contact the Superintendent, or designee, and the student will be excluded from school and school related functions, until a Bloodborne Disease Review Panel (BDRP) is established, convened, and makes a recommendation to the Superintendent, or designee. The Superintendent, or designee will render a decision regarding the student's attendance at school and school related functions.

C. The Superintendent, or designee, per section B of this regulation, shall establish a Bloodborne Disease Review Panel (BDRP) consisting of the Supervisor of Student Health Services, a Loudoun County Health Department representative, the Assistant Superintendent for Pupil Services, or designee, and a school division representative to review all pertinent information and make recommendations to the Superintendent, or designee. Persons contributing information to the BDRP may include the attending physician, principal, and the parent.

D. The BDRP will obtain a medical evaluation of the student, with permission from the parent/ guardian or adult student, for use in making a recommendation to the Superintendent, or designee. If a potential exposure occurs as a result of a bite or contact with other bodily fluids on school property, Virginia Code §32.1-45.1 provides a process to test the student that exposed another student or adult and to verify that a bloodborne disease is present, or not.

E. The BDRP will meet and review all pertinent information and make recommendations to the Superintendent, or designee, within five (5) school days following the exclusion of the student and any student that may have been exposed to the bloodborne disease. The recommendations shall include, but not be limited to, a decision to exclude the student/s and a timetable regarding future school attendance, if appropriate.

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F. Within five (5) school days following their receipt of the report from the BDRP, the Superintendent, or designee, shall notify the student and their family of their decision to re-admit or to continue to exclude such student from the school or school related functions. Any person aggrieved by the decision of the Superintendent, or designee, may appeal to the School Board, per Policy 2350.

G. All information, regarding students that are suspected of or diagnosed with a bloodborne disease shall be disseminated through the Department of Pupil Services on a need-to-know basis.

H. School administrators may also report exposure to their immediate Level Director, as appropriate.

I. Confidentiality, regarding the student, will be maintained by all involved stakeholders.

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